

[I225] Statistical Signal Processing(E) Office Hour 1

1. Imagine you are looking at the digital thermometer outside the university. We want to model the temperature recorded there.

Let $T(t, \omega)$ be the stochastic process of temperature at time t (hours past midnight).

The randomness ω comes from which specific **day** of the year we are looking at (e.g., April 1st vs. October 1st).

- A. Classify the following events: (constant value, random variable, stochastic process, or realization)

- [1] The predicted temperature curve for tomorrow, from 0:00 to 23:59.
- [2] The temperature measured at exactly 8:00 AM across every possible day of the year.
- [3] The collection of every temperature reading ever taken at this station at every second of every day.
- [4] The temperature at exactly 12:00 PM on January 1st, 2024.
- [5] A value representing the average yearly temperature of the city.

- B. Based on how temperature behaves throughout a 24-hour cycle, would you classify the temperature process $T(t, \omega)$ as Wide-Sense Stationary (WSS), Strict-Sense Stationary (SSS), or Non-Stationary? Justify your answer using the **average** of the process.

- C. Suppose you want to find the average temperature of the city. You have two choices:
- a. **Time Average:** Record the temperature of **one specific day** and average it over 24 hours.
 - b. **Ensemble Average:** Measure the temperature at **exactly 12:00 PM** across 365 different days and average those values.

Will these two averages give you the same result? Based on this, is the process **Mean-Ergodic**?

A. Definition of Stochastic Process

Item	Classification	Conceptual Explanation
1	Realization	It is a single function of time. Once the "day" is picked, there is no more randomness; it's just a line on a graph.
2	Random Variable	Time is "frozen". We are looking at a single moment, but the value changes depending on which day you pick.
3	Stochastic Process	This is the "Whole Thing". It includes all the days (randomness) and all the hours (time).
4	Constant	Both time and the day are fixed. It is a single, historical measurement.
5	Constant	It's just a number. It doesn't change with time or which day you look at.

B. Stationary

Classification: Non-Stationary.

Reasoning:

For a process to be WSS (and by extension SSS), the **mean** must be constant for all time: $E[T(t)] = \eta_T$.

In our weather model, the ensemble mean $E[T(t)]$ represents the average temperature at a specific hour t across many days. Because of the solar cycle, the average temperature at 2:00 PM is significantly higher than at 2:00 AM. Since $E[T(14:00)] \neq E[T(02:00)]$, the mean is **time-dependent**, making the process **non-stationary**.

C. Ergodicity

Classification: Not Ergodic.

Reasoning: A process is Mean-Ergodic if the **time average** of a single realization converges to the **ensemble average**.

- The **time average** of one day captures the full cycle (cold night to warm day).
- The **ensemble average** at 12:00 PM only captures the "peak" heat of the days.

Since the average of a single "slice" of time (the whole day) does not represent the statistical average of the "whole group" at a fixed moment (noon), the process is not ergodic.

2. Consider a signal that has a constant DC offset A plus a random oscillating component:

$$X(t) = A + \cos(\omega_0 t + \theta)$$

- A is a constant.
- θ is a random variable uniformly distributed between $[0, 2\pi]$.

- Calculate the average: $E[X(t)]$
- Calculate the Autocorrelation: $R_{XX}(t_1, t_2)$
- Calculate Autocovariance: $C_{XX}(t_1, t_2)$

A. Calculate the average: $E[X(t)]$

$$\begin{aligned} E[X(t)] &= E[A + \cos(\omega_0 t + \theta)] \\ &= E[A] + E[\cos(\omega_0 t + \theta)] \\ &= A + \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \cos(\omega_0 t + \theta) \cdot f(\theta) d\theta \\ &= A + \int_0^{2\pi} \cos(\omega_0 t + \theta) \frac{1}{2\pi} d\theta \\ &= A + \frac{1}{2\pi} \cdot [\sin(\omega_0 t + \theta)]_0^{2\pi} \\ E[X(t)] &= A \end{aligned}$$

B. Calculate the Autocorrelation.

$$\begin{aligned} R_{XX}(t_1, t_2) &= E[X(t_1) \cdot X(t_2)] \\ &= E[(A + \cos(\omega_0 t_1 + \theta)) (A + \cos(\omega_0 t_2 + \theta))] \\ &= E[A^2] + E[A \cos(\omega_0 t_1 + \theta)] + E[A \cos(\omega_0 t_2 + \theta)] + E[\cos(\omega_0 t_1 + \theta) \cos(\omega_0 t_2 + \theta)] \\ &\quad \boxed{\cos(A) \cdot \cos(B) = \frac{1}{2} (\cos(A + B) + \cos(A - B))} \\ &= A^2 + 0 + 0 + E \left[\frac{1}{2} (\cos(\omega_0 t_1 + \omega_0 t_2 + 2\theta) + \cos(\omega_0 t_1 - \omega_0 t_2)) \right] \\ &= A^2 + \frac{1}{2} E[\cos(\omega_0(t_1 + t_2) + 2\theta)] + \frac{1}{2} E[\cos(\omega_0(t_1 - t_2))] \\ &= A^2 + 0 + \frac{1}{2} \cos(\omega_0(t_1 - t_2)) \\ &= A^2 + \frac{1}{2} \cos(\omega_0(t_1 - t_2)) \end{aligned}$$

C. Calculate the Autocovariance

$$\begin{aligned} C_{XX}(t_1, t_2) &= R_{XX}(t_1, t_2) - E[X(t_1)]E[X(t_2)] \\ &= A^2 + \frac{1}{2} \cos(\omega_0(t_1 - t_2)) - A^2 \end{aligned}$$

$$= \frac{1}{2} \cos(\omega_0(t_1 - t_2))$$

3. You are designing a buffer for a video streaming app. The video requires **100 MB** to start playing. Because of a bad Wi-Fi connection, the download progress (measured in Megabytes or MB) behaves randomly. At every second:

- **Success (50% chance):** You download **1 MB**.
- **Buffering (50% chance):** You download **0 MB** (stay in place).

Let $X[n]$ be the total MB received after n seconds.

- Your app shows a progress bar to the user. Based on the Ensemble Mean $E[X[n]]$, after how many seconds should the app tell the user the download will 'likely' be finished?
- Using only the ensemble mean to predict the finish time results in a 'premature notification' 50% of the time (the app says it's done, but the file is still buffering). To provide a more reliable estimate, we want to find the time n where even an 'unlucky' user—defined as being one standard deviation ($\sigma_X[n]$) below the mean progress—has finished the download.

(**Task:** Solve for the time n required to reach the 100 MB target such that $E[X[n]] - \sigma_X[n] = 100$.)

First, let's define the $X[n]$

$$X[n] = \sum_{i=1}^n Z[i]$$

where $Z[i]$ is an i.i.d (independent and identically distributed) sequence of step variables with the following PMF (probability mass function):

$$P(Z[i] = 1) = P(Z[i] = 0) = \frac{1}{2}$$

A. Ensemble Mean $E[X[n]]$

To show when the download will likely to be finished, we need to know the average amount of received MB after n seconds.

$$\begin{aligned} E[X[n]] &= E\left[\sum_{i=1}^n Z[i]\right] \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n E[Z[i]] \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n \left(1 \cdot \frac{1}{2} + 0 \cdot \frac{1}{2}\right) \quad \boxed{\text{Bernoulli distribution}} \\ &= \frac{1}{2}n \end{aligned}$$

Since the app need to download 100 MB of data before the video can be played, we need to find value of n so that $E[X[n]] = 100$.

With $E[X[n]] = \frac{1}{2}n$, we can find that on average, users need to wait for $n = 200$ seconds before the video can be played.

B. To find the standard deviation, we first need to find the variance.

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Var}(X[n]) &= E[(X[n] - E[X[n]])^2] = E[X[n]^2] - E[X[n]]^2 \\
 &= \left(\sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^n E[Z[i]Z[j]] \right) - \frac{1}{4}n^2 \\
 &\quad \boxed{\text{As } Z[n] \text{ is i.i.d., } E[Z[i]Z[j]] = E[Z[i]]E[Z[j]] \text{ when } i \neq j} \\
 &= \left(\sum_{i=1}^n E[Z[i]^2] \right) + \left(\sum_i \sum_{j \neq i} E[Z[i]]E[Z[j]] \right) - \frac{1}{4}n^2 \\
 &= n\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) + n(n-1)\left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^2 - \frac{1}{4}n^2 \\
 &= \frac{1}{4}(2n + n^2 - n - n^2) \\
 &= \frac{1}{4}n
 \end{aligned}$$

From that, standard deviation can be calculated as $\sigma_X[n] = \sqrt{\text{Var}(X[n])} = \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{n}$

Finally, we can find the answer:

$$\begin{aligned}
 E[X[n]] - \sigma_X[n] &= 100 \\
 \frac{1}{2}n - \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{n} &= 100 \\
 n - \sqrt{n} &= 200 \\
 n - \sqrt{n} - 200 &= 0 \quad \boxed{\text{use quadratic formula}} \\
 \sqrt{n} &= \frac{1 + \sqrt{1 + 800}}{2} \approx \frac{1 + 28.3}{2} \approx 14.65 \\
 n &\approx (14.65)^2 \approx 215 \text{ seconds}
 \end{aligned}$$

4. You have a noise signal $X(t)$ that represents the background hum of a microphone. The probability density function (PDF) of this noise is **Uniform**, meaning it is equally likely to be any value between **0** and **1** ($f_X(x) = 1$ for $0 \leq x \leq 1$).

You pass this signal through an amplifier (a memoryless system) that doubles the signal:

$$Y(t) = 2X(t)$$

- A. What is the new range of the output $Y(t)$?
- B. As the total probability must still equal 1, but the range has changed (from question A), what must happen to the “height” of PDF ($f_Y(y)$)?
- C. Use the transformation formula to find $f_Y(y)$:

$$f_Y(y) = \frac{f_X(x)}{|J(x)|}$$

where Jacobian $J(x) = \frac{dy}{dx}$

A. From the definition of:

$$Y(t) = 2X(t)$$

The system behaves like a multiplier. ($Y = 2X$)

- When X is at its minimum (0), $Y = 2(0) = 0$.
- When X is at its maximum (1), $Y = 2(1) = 2$

Therefore, the output Y has range of $[0,2]$.

B. Since the range of output is double the input, the PDF of $Y(t)$ needs to shrink by half, so the total probability is still 1.

C. Firstly we need to find the value of the Jacobian $J(x)$:

$$\begin{aligned} J(x) &= \frac{dy}{dx} \\ &= \frac{d}{dx}(2x) \\ &= 2 \end{aligned}$$

With that, we can find $f_Y(y)$:

$$\begin{aligned} f_Y(y) &= \frac{f_X(x)}{|J(x)|} \\ &= \frac{1}{|2|} \end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$$f_Y(y) = \frac{1}{2} \text{ for } 0 \leq y \leq 2$$